

Executive Summary

Foreign giving is a big deal for universities, where institutions like UC Berkeley, Michigan, Columbia, and others receive hundreds of millions of dollars. There are countries such as Qatar, England, and China that contribute billions to numerous higher education institutions. Compared with these schools, UVA falls in the middle of the overall market, with approximately \$23 million in giving from 98 gifts and 15 countries. To increase its foreign giving, UVA should focus on expanding into countries that contribute large amounts to universities but are not currently major sources for UVA, especially Qatar and China. UVA should also work to increase the total number of gifts and diversify its donor base by using its international students, alumni network, and global academic reputation.

Summary of Findings

After analyzing the data, my findings are that schools like UC Berkeley, Michigan, Columbia, and many others are receiving over hundreds of millions of dollars. Alongside that, some of the biggest donating countries are Qatar, England, China, and more, with total donations going into the billions for some. When UVA is compared to these schools, they fall above the median in areas of giving, but still very far from the top. They reported around \$23 million with around 98 gifts, from 15 countries, but for UVA needs to increase these numbers to increase their foreign gifts.

For UVA to increase the money they receive, they need to step in the ring with more countries. Out of the top countries giving to UVA and the top countries that give to universities, only two of those ten countries overlapped. UVA should talk to countries like Qatar and China because they are two of the most valuable foreign donors. Outside of talking to other countries, the most important thing is to increase those gift totals because some of the top schools receive over a thousand gifts. This is easier said than done but increasing number of gifts and attempting to diversify where those gifts come from are of top priority.

UVA has an extremely diverse student body and takes in many foreign exchange, so they have a huge alumni connection that stretches the globe. They have a global reputation too with both excellent academics and sports, which can appeal to many different crowds. While this will not be easy, I think UVA is in an excellent position and will only continue to increase their gifts to the university.